Activity 5: Zappos: Build an Internal Brand Adoption System

Objective: Champion adoption of the service brand through culture and employee enablement Expected output: Internal-brand adoption charter and 30-day activation sprint Primary source: https://www.zapposinsights.com/about/culture

Goal

Use Zappos's public culture materials to design an adoption system that aligns meaning, capability and reinforcement.

Real-world scenario

Zappos Insights publicly describes a culture shaped by core values and employee behaviours, and offers culture-focused learning based on the company's experience.

A Singapore home-services marketplace has launched the promise 'Care you can count on', but customer support, operations and field partners interpret it differently.

Evidence boundary

Public case facts and fictional learner data must never be mixed. Every numerical or organisational training input is labelled as an assumption.

Training assumptions / guardrails

- The marketplace, interview statements and performance data are fictional and not Zappos information.
- Employees understand the words but lack examples, authority and aligned performance measures.
- Field partners are contractors; adoption must include onboarding and quality governance.
- The sponsor can change coaching, recognition and escalation rules within 30 days.

Questions

1. What must employees understand, believe, know and be able to do?
2. Which three behaviours best express dependable care at critical moments?
3. What systems currently contradict the promise?
4. How should champions, managers and leaders reinforce adoption?

Detailed activity procedure

Step 1: Diagnose the adoption gap

Sort evidence into meaning, belief, capability, authority and reinforcement gaps by role.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 2: Define critical moments

Select booking, arrival, work completion and complaint handling; describe the desired customer outcome.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 3: Specify behaviours

Write observable behaviours, tools, boundaries and escalation paths for each critical moment.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 4: Design the champion network

Assign sponsor, cross-functional champions, managers and partner leads with explicit responsibilities.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 5: Align reinforcement

Change one coaching ritual, one recognition mechanism and one metric that currently rewards the wrong behaviour.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 6: Plan the sprint

Sequence communication, practice, manager coaching, field observation and feedback across 30 days.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Deliverable

Internal-brand adoption charter and 30-day activation sprint

Acceptance criteria

The plan names role-specific behaviours, tools and guardrails; assigns sponsor/champion/manager ownership; and includes leading, behavioural and outcome evidence.

Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which customer or employee insight changed your recommendation most, and why?
2. What evidence would you request before investing or scaling?
3. Which stakeholder owns the next service-brand decision?
4. What should the organisation start, stop or continue?

Facilitator debrief

Compare recommendations against relevance, distinctiveness, deliverability and evidence quality. Surface unsupported causal claims. Close by naming one decision, one owner and one validation action.

Source note

Source accessed 17 August 2026: https://www.zapposinsights.com/about/culture